

Reflective Journal for Lab 02

Introduction

Lab 01 introduced me to the Iris dataset and showed me how Python can be used to explore and visualize data. This reflection covers what I learned, what I found challenging, and what I want to improve.

Description of Experience or Topic

The Iris dataset contains 150 samples, 4 features, and 3 classes: Setosa, Versicolor, and Virginica.

From the visualizations, I noticed that:

- Setosa generally has shorter sepals than the other two classes.
- Versicolor and Virginica generally have larger widths than Setosa.
- Virginica appears to be the largest overall in sepal length and width.

I would be interested in seeing whether these patterns stay the same with a larger sample size.

Personal Reflection

John Grubbs: At first, the code felt overwhelming because there was a lot to understand. At the same time, much of the complexity was abstracted away by the Python libraries, so individual commands often did more than they appeared to. The visualizations helped me understand the dataset better because I could clearly see differences between the three flower classes. This showed me how useful visualization can be when analyzing data. I also gained more experience using Google Colab and Jupyter Notebook cells in VS Code. I am interested in seeing which environment I prefer as I continue working through the course.

Discussion of Improvements and Learning

John Grubbs: This lab helped me become more comfortable with Python, notebook environments, and data visualization. In future labs, I want to spend more time experimenting with individual lines of code so I better understand what each function is doing. I can also apply what I learned by using visualizations to explore datasets before moving on to machine learning models.

Conclusion

John Grubbs: Overall, this lab gave me a useful introduction to the Iris dataset and data visualization in Python. The code was overwhelming at first, but it became easier to understand as I worked through the lab and connected the code to the visual results.